

Standard Chartered

2Q was OK

Earnings Review

Key takeaways

- Decent if flattish report from Standard Chartered, with PBT at USD 2.3bn
- Another USD 1bn quarter from Markets and Wealth. Too early to see a negative China rule change impact.
- 2026 Funding plan done. Capital at 13.8% post buyback. Spread neutral today we think.

Beat supported by lower impairment

We thought the 2Q report from Standard Chartered was OK. On an adjusted basis, PBT was \$2.3bn, -5% qoq as credit impairments halved. The results were characterised by a weaker outcome from Markets, reflecting the business mix compared to other investment banks, solid outcomes from Global Banking and flattish Wealth, where there have been recent concerns re: the impact of China's restrictions on cross-border accounts. The numbers did beat forecasts and there was a \$1bn share buyback announced. We see these numbers as broadly spread neutral this morning.

Markets solid, Wealth flat

The Markets business reported revenues of \$1.1bn, -5% yoy, -6% qoq. FX, Credit Trading and volumes were all supportive. Global Banking revenues came in at \$651m flat on quarter but +15% yoy thanks to good origination. Wealth revenues were sustained at \$1.1bn, driven by Investment Products +43% yoy but only +2% qoq. Assets under Management were \$258bn +11%. Net New Money was \$9bn (ex. Deposits). We thought other divisions' progress was lacklustre. In terms of geography we note better outcomes yoy in HK, Korea and UK made up for some quite sharp drops in Singapore and China.

Early alerts up, funding plan done

Early alerts on the loan portfolio were +30% yoy at \$5.8bn, mostly relating to the Middle East. Asset quality is however stable with Stage 3 loans at \$5.7bn -2% qoq. Proforma for the \$1bn share buyback announced, the CET1 ratio is likely around 13.8% (reported: 14.2%). Note the bank's \$9bn funding plan has been completed (\$7.3bn senior, \$1.6bn AT1 done) and the bank may look to prefund 2027. We note \$1.1bn in T2 maturities remaining through year end.

29 July 2026

High Grade Credit
United Kingdom
Banks

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Valuation & risk

StanChart (STANLN)

We adopt a balanced view of Standard Chartered. High dependence on Markets income, in spite of positioning in some of the world's highest growth regions, is a sticking point in our view. Nevertheless, we acknowledge the progress the group continues to make in recent quarters and the strong balance sheet. We think bonds should trade a bit wider when compared to UK peers. We are UW the \$5.005% '30 sr holdco. The \$4.644% is by no means expensive whereas the subs can seem tight to senior holdcos, in our view. The \$7.014% legacy T1s lack a Capital Disqualification Event clause which could allow early redemption but the bank considers they are the equivalent of Tier 2 for life, which is why it did not take the opportunity of low cash prices in 2023 to buy back these securities. Opco CDS levels look fair.

Downside risks are uncertainty emanating from volatile markets income dependency, and exposures to emerging markets under pressure from volatile USD. China CRE, HK asset quality not out of the woods albeit that these seem in the rear view mirror now. Upside risks are less near term pressure than expected on the bank's core earnings.

Analyst Certification

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Security/Loan pricing

Standard Chartered / STANLN

Security	Amt	Maturity date	Ratings Moody's/S&P/Fitch	Price	Price date	Yield (%)	Spread (Govt+bps)
Subordinated, EUR, Y5:CDS					28-Jul-2026		82
Senior Unsecured, EUR, Y5:CDS					28-Jul-2026		43
7.014, Tier1, USD, Perp/2049:B	750	30-DEC-2049	Ba1/BBB-/BBB-	100.83	28-Jul-2026	6.22	112
4.75,, USD, Perp/2049:B	1,250	31-DEC-2049	Ba1/BB+/BBB-	93.17	28-Jul-2026	6.38	200
3.265,, USD, 2036:B	1,250	18-FEB-2036	Baa2/BBB/BBB+	91.25	28-Jul-2026	5.46	109
SLA, EUR, Y5:CDS					14-Jul-2026		44
4.3,, USD, 2027:B	1,250	19-FEB-2027	Baa2/BBB/BBB+	99.77	28-Jul-2026	4.72	64
7.75,, USD, Perp/2049:B	1,250	31-DEC-2049	Ba1/BB+/BBB-	102.22	28-Jul-2026	5.53	133
4.644,, USD, 2031:B	2,000	01-APR-2031	A3/BBB+/A	98.53	28-Jul-2026	5.09	73
5.005, Senior, USD, 2030:B	1,500	15-OCT-2030	A3/BBB+/A	100.32	14-Jul-2026	4.90	70
7,, USD, Perp/2049:B	1,000	31-DEC-2049	Ba1/BB+/BBB-	99.37	28-Jul-2026	7.09	248

For pricing information refer to "Other Important Disclosures" below.

B=Bond; L=Loan; CS=Capital Security (Not including Equity Preferred); CDS=Credit Default Swap; EP=Equity Preferred

Disclosures

Important Disclosures

Credit opinion history

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Security	Date ^{R1}	Action	Recommendation	Price
Subordinated, EUR, Y5:CDS	30-Jun-2025		Neutral	
Senior Unsecured, EUR, Y5:CDS	30-Jun-2025		Neutral	
7.014, Tier1, USD, Perp/2049:B	30-Jun-2025		Underweight	
4.75,, USD, Perp/2049:B	30-Jun-2025		Underweight	
3.265,, USD, 2036:B	30-Jun-2025		Underweight	
SLA, EUR, Y5:CDS	30-Jun-2025		Buy Protection	
4.3,, USD, 2027:B	30-Jun-2025		Underweight	
7.75,, USD, Perp/2049:B	30-Jun-2025		Underweight	
4.644,, USD, 2031:B	30-Jun-2025		Marketweight	
5.005, Senior, USD, 2030:B	30-Jun-2025		Underweight	
7,, USD, Perp/2049:B	10-Jun-2026	Initial	Overweight	100.21

Table reflects credit opinion history as of previous business day's close.^{R1}First date of recommendation within the last 36 months, if for an issuer or within the last 12 months, if for a security or loan. The investment opinion system is contained at the end of the report under the heading "BofA Global Research Credit Opinion Key."

Pricing information in the table is provided for each action where available. In the case of bonds, loans, capital securities and equity preferreds, the price shown reflects the nominal cash price for the security; and in the case of CDS, the price shown reflects the spread, on the date of the relevant action.

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Neutral: No purchase or sale of CDS is recommended.

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Corporate Credit Issuer Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 30 Jun 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R2}	Count	Percent
Buy	132	38.60%	Buy	113	85.61%
Hold	163	47.66%	Hold	136	83.44%
Sell	47	13.74%	Sell	41	87.23%

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